

Question:

A 16-year-old teenager presents to the pediatrician with his mother. After she leaves the room he tells the physician that he is worried about puberty. All of his friends have had growth spurts, started building muscle mass, and their voices have changed while he still feels underdeveloped. The physician takes a complete history and performs a thorough physical examination. He goes through the patient’s past medical records and growth charts and notes physical findings documented over the last five years, concluding that the patient has delayed puberty. Which of the following findings supports his conclusion? Answer Choices: A. The absence of linear growth acceleration by age of 13 years B. The absence of testicular enlargement by age of 14 years C. Presence of gynecomastia at age of 15 years D. The absence of an adult type of pubic hair distribution by age of 16 years

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>The physician is thinking about the fact that puberty is a complex process that is influenced by a variety of factors, including genetics, hormones, and environmental factors. The patient's symptoms of delayed puberty, such as a lack of growth spurts, muscle mass, and voice change, are consistent with a variety of underlying causes, such as hypogonadism, hypothyroidism, and chromosomal abnormalities. The physician is also thinking about the fact that the patient's past medical records and growth charts may provide important information about his developmental history, such as his rate of linear growth, sexual maturation, and pubic hair distribution. The physical examination may also provide clues about the underlying cause of the patient's delayed puberty, such as the presence of gynecomastia, which can be caused by a variety of factors, including hypogonadism. </think> <answer> A . The absence of linear growth acceleration by age of 13 years </answer>

